



# NONVERBAL DELIVERY

Session IV. Group & Team Theory

# Learning objectives

**Demonstrate**

Demonstrate how to use movement to increase the effectiveness of your presentation.



**Demonstrate**

Demonstrate how to use visual aids effectively in your presentation.



**Demonstrate**

Demonstrate three ways to improve nonverbal communication.

# Chapter outline

1. Nonverbal communication definition
2. Types of nonverbal communication
3. Movement in Your Speech
4. Visual Aids
5. Nonverbal Strategies for Success with Your Audience

# 1. Nonverbal Communication Is Fluid

Nonverbal communication is the process of conveying a message without the use of words.

Include:

- Gestures
- Facial expressions
- Tone of voice
- Timing
- Posture
- and where you stand as you communicate.

## 2. Eight types of nonverbal communication

1. Space

2. Time

3. Physical  
characteristics

4. Body movements

5. Touch

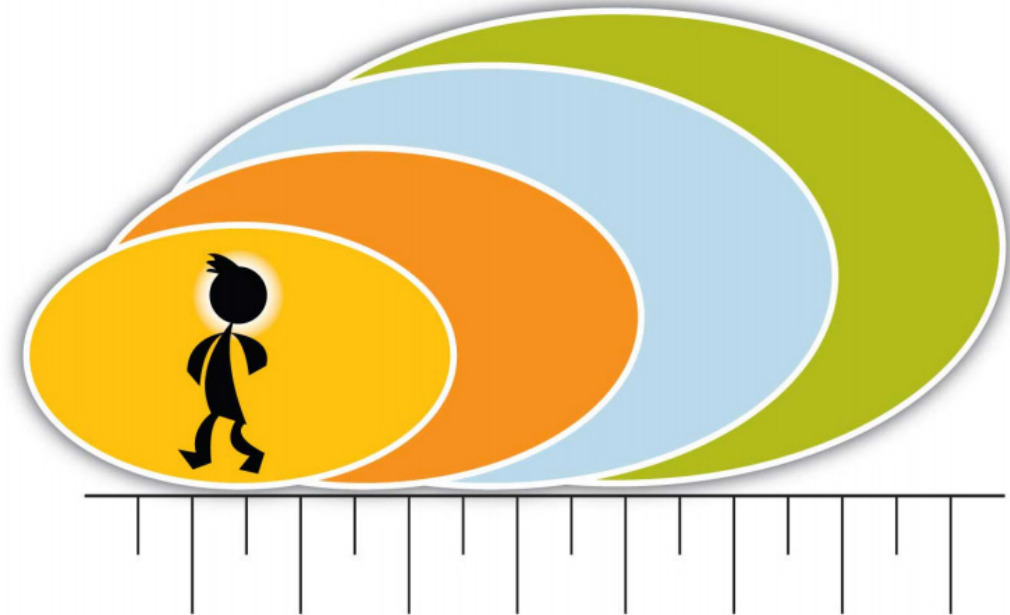
6. Paralanguage

7. Artifacts

8. Environment



# Space



Intimate, Personal, Social, and Public Space

# Environment

- Environment involves the physical and psychological aspects of the communication context.
- The perception of one's environment influences one's reaction to it.
- The results produced in the environment, designed to facilitate creativity, interaction, and collaboration, are worth the effort.



### 3. Movement in Your Speech



#### **Let's start with behaviors to avoid:**

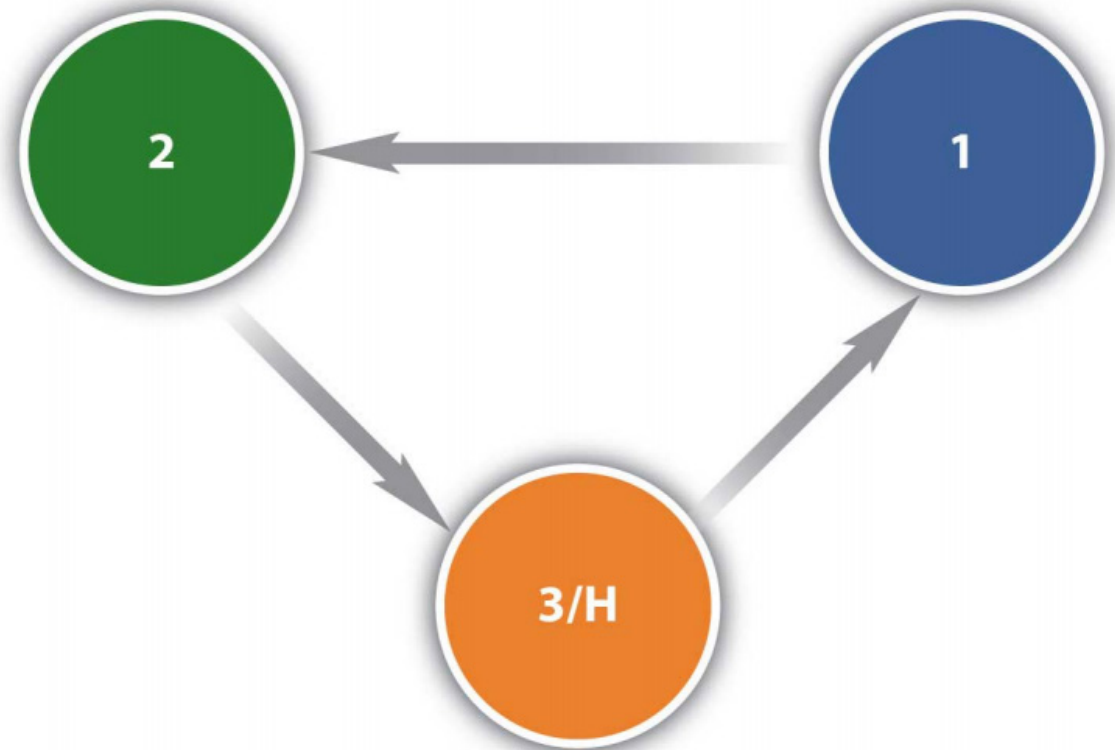
Who would you rather listen to: a speaker who moves confidently across the stage or one who hides behind the podium; one who expresses herself nonverbally with purpose and meaning or one who crosses his arms or clings to the lectern?

Audiences are most likely to respond positively to open, dynamic speakers who convey the feeling of being at ease with their bodies.

# Positions on the Stage

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- The speaker's triangle indicates where the speaker starts in **the introduction (1)**
- Moves to the second position **for the first point (2)**
- Across for **the second point (1)**
- Then returns to the original position to make **the third point and conclusion (1)**



# Gestures

- **Gestures** involve using your arms and hands while communicating.
- **Anticipation step:** speakers lead up to a main point, they raise their hand slightly, perhaps waist high.
- **Implementation step:** using your arms and hands above your waist.
- **Relaxation step:** the letting go motion complements your residual message, concludes the motion.



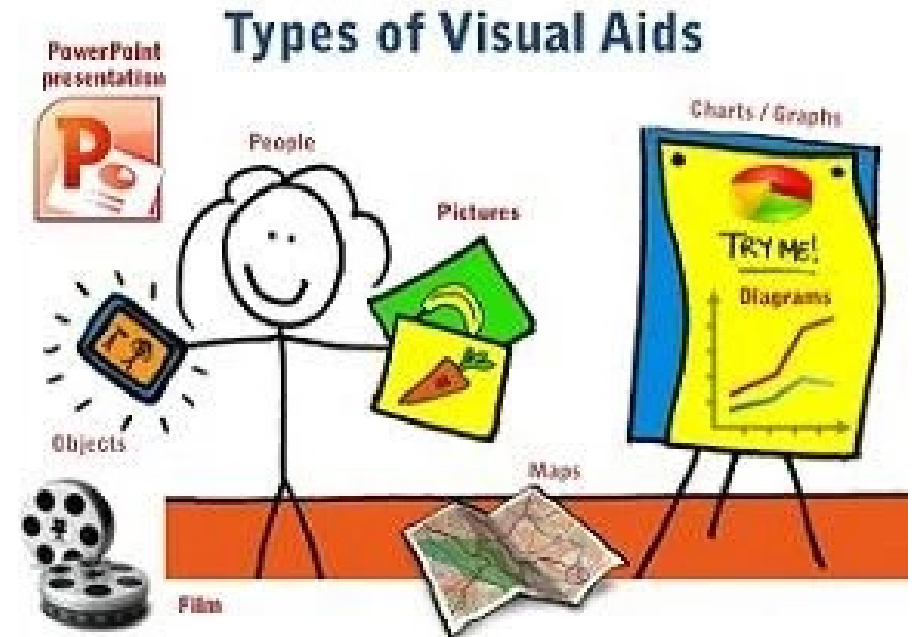
# Facial Gestures

- Facial gestures involve using your face to display feelings and attitudes nonverbally.
- They may reinforce, or contradict, the spoken word, and their impact cannot be underestimated.
- Facial gestures should reflect the tone and emotion of your verbal communication.
- Eye contact: The single most important facial gesture; it refers to the speaker's gaze that engages the audience members.



## 4. Visual Aids

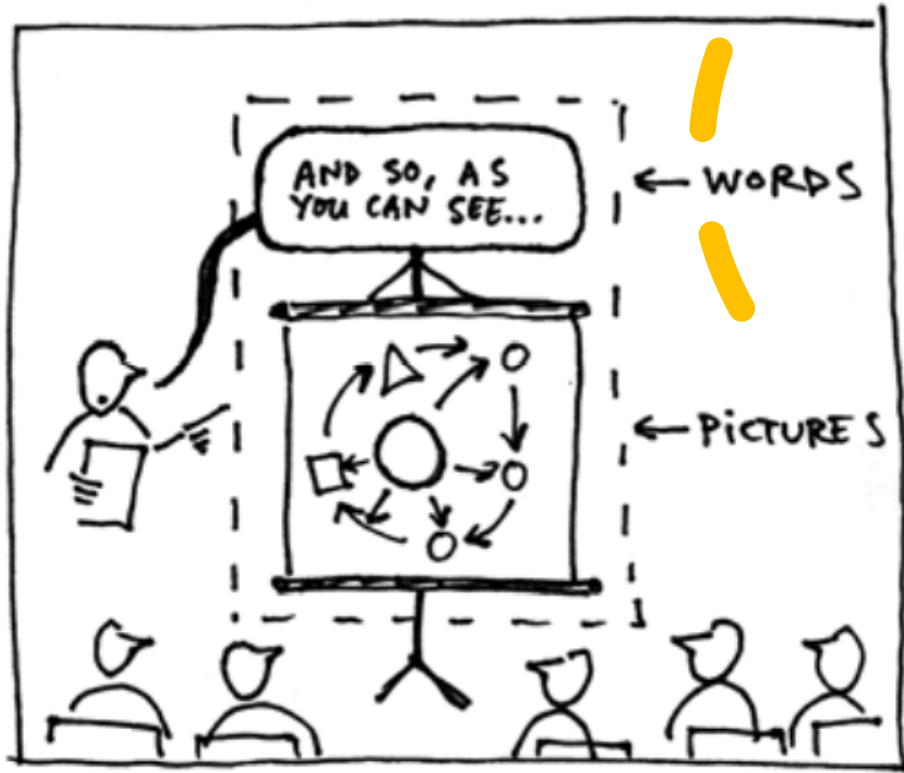
- **Visual aids** are an important nonverbal aspect of your speech that you can control.
- **Include:**
  - Handouts
  - Overhead transparencies
  - Drawings on the whiteboard
  - PowerPoint slides
  - And many other types of props.



# Visual aids accomplish several goals:

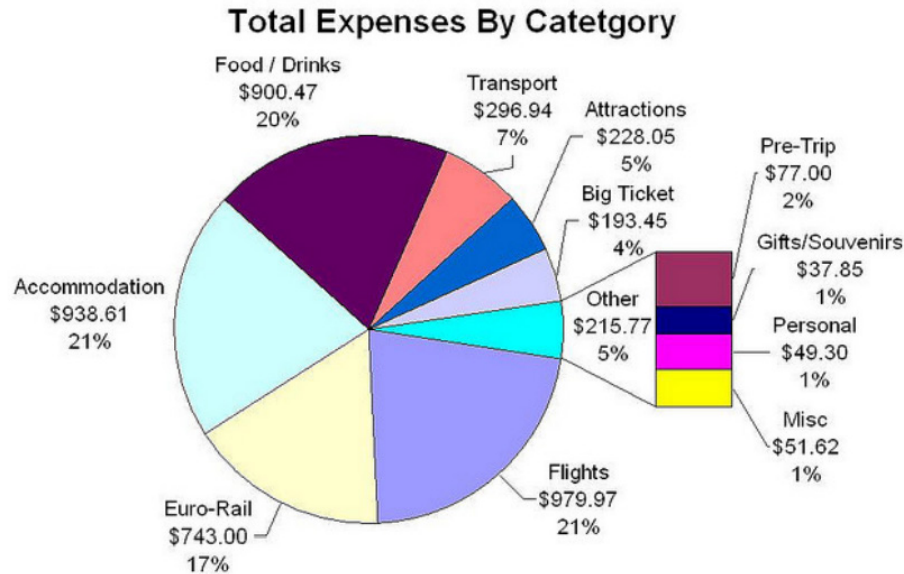
- Make your speech more interesting
- Enhance your credibility as a speaker
- Serve as guides to transitions, helping the audience stay on track
- Communicate complex or intriguing information in a short period of time
- Reinforce your verbal message
- Help the audience use and retain the information

# Purpose, Emphasis, Support, and Clarity



- The purpose for each **visual aid should be clear, and almost speak for itself.**
- Visual aids provide necessary support for your position, illustrate relationships, and demonstrate trends

# Methods and Materials



Bar and pie graphs can clearly demonstrate results.

- **Chart or Diagram:** to show a timeline of events to date.
- **Bar or Pie graph:** to show the percentage.
- **Pictures**
- **Map**
- **Sound and music**
- **Video clips**
- **Flip charts**
- **Handouts**
- **Transparencies and slides**
- ....

# Preparing Visual Aids

**Your visual aids should meet the following criteria:**

- **Big:** They should be eligible for everyone, and should be “back row certified.”
- **Clear:** Your audience should “get it” the first time they see it.
- **Simple:** They should serve to simplify the concepts they illustrate.
- **Consistent:** They should reinforce continuity by using the same visual style.



# Using Visual Aids

## **Here are some Dos and Don'ts:**

1. Do make a clear connection between your words and the visual aid for the audience.
2. Do not distract the audience with your visual aid, blocking their view of you or adjusting the visual aid repeatedly while trying to speak.
3. Do speak to your audience—not to the whiteboard, the video, or other visual aids.

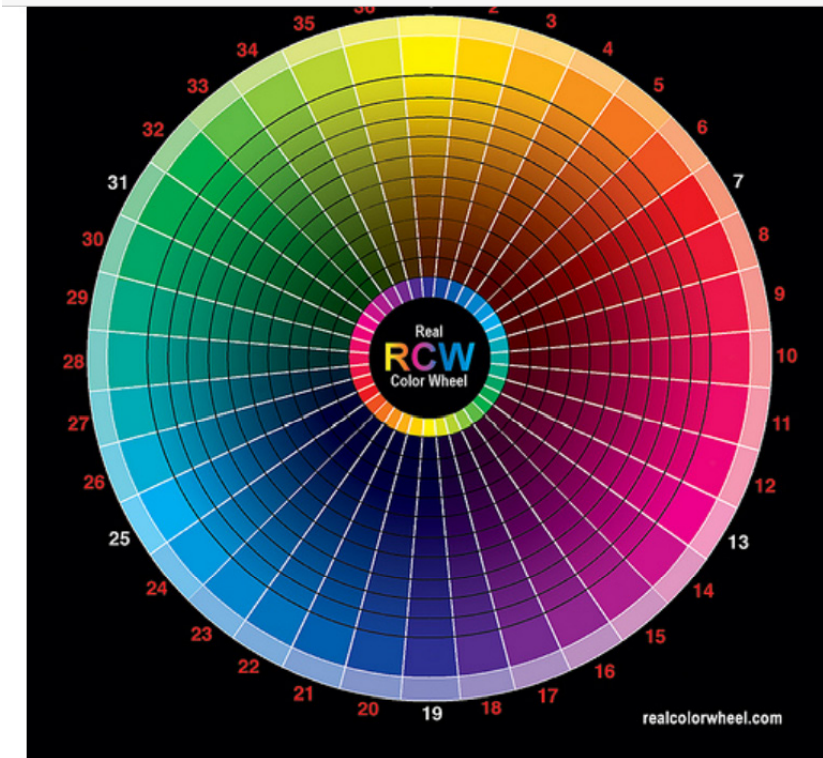
# Using PowerPoint as a Visual Aid

How you prepare your slides and use the tool will determine your effectiveness.



# Use of Color

- People love color, and will appreciate the visual stimulation of a colorful presentation.
- The color can also distract and turn off an audience.
- You will be selecting which color you want to use for headers or key words, and how they relate the colors in the visual images.

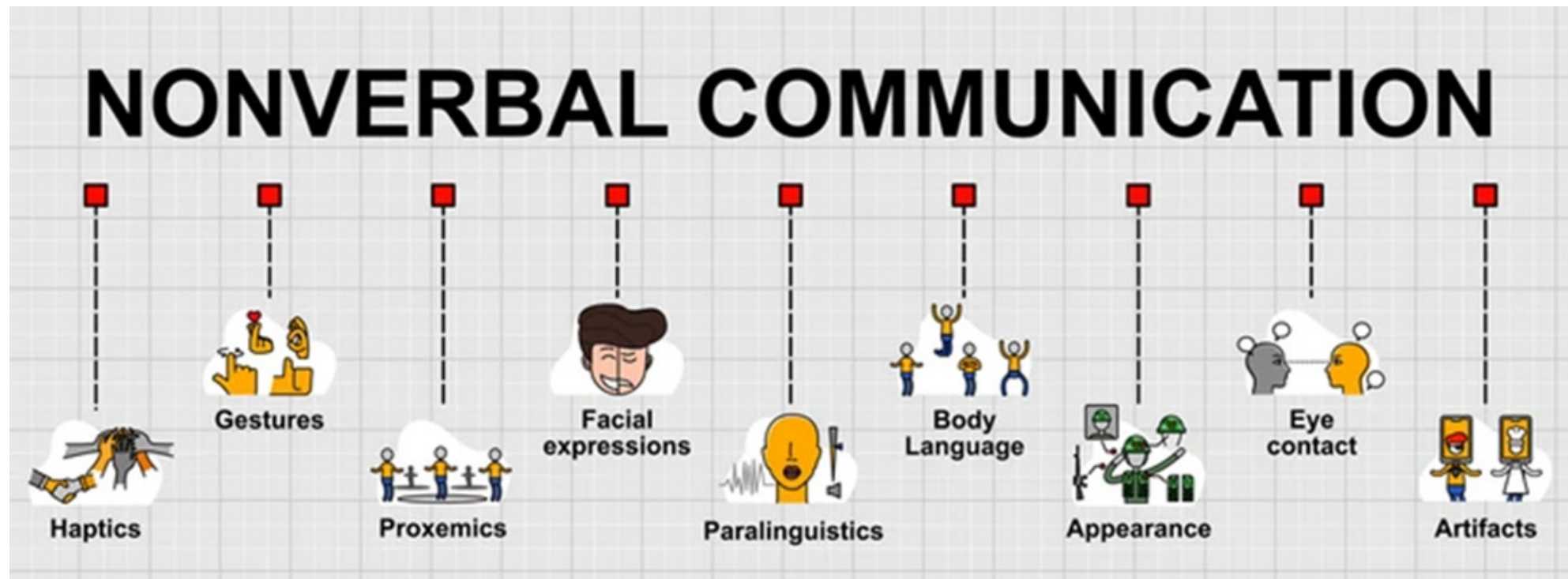


# Helpful Hints for Visual Aids

- Keep visual aids simple.
- Use one key idea per slide.
- Avoid clutter, noise, and overwhelming slides.
- Use large, bold fonts that the audience can read from at least twenty feet from the screen.
- Use contrasting colors to create a dynamic effect
- Use analogous colors to unify your presentation.
- Use clip art with permission and sparingly.
- Edit and proofread each slide with care and caution.
- Use copies of your visuals available as handouts after your presentation.
- Check the presentation room beforehand.
- Have a backup plan

## 5. Nonverbal Strategies for Success with Your Audience

- Watch Reactions
- Enroll an Observer
- Focus on a Specific Type of Nonverbal Communication





# Exercises

1. Watch a television program without the sound. Can you understand the program? Write a description of the program and include what you found easy to understand, and what presented a challenge, and present it to the class.
2. Observe communication in your environment. Focus on specific actions like face touching, blink rate, or head nodding and write a brief description of what you observe. Share with classmates.
3. Interview someone from a different culture than your own and ask them to share a specific cultural difference in nonverbal communication—for example, a nonverbal gesture that is not used in polite company. Write a brief description and present it to the class.

Q & A  
TIME!



# Persuasive Presentations

SESSION IV: GROUPS & TEAMS (IN) ACTION

# Chapter outlines

1. What Is Persuasion?
2. Meeting the Listener's Basic Needs
3. Speaking Ethically
4. Elevator Speech

# LEARNING OBJECTIVES

**By the end of this section, you will be able to:**

1. Demonstrate an understanding of the importance of persuasion.
2. Describe similarities and differences between persuasion and motivation.
3. Identify and describe several basic needs that people seek to fulfill when they communicate.
4. Demonstrate the importance of ethics as part of the persuasion process.
5. Discuss the basic parts of an elevator speech.

# 1. What Is Persuasion?

**Persuasion is an act or process of presenting arguments to move, motivate, or change your audience**

Persuasion can be implicit or explicit and can have both positive and negative effects.

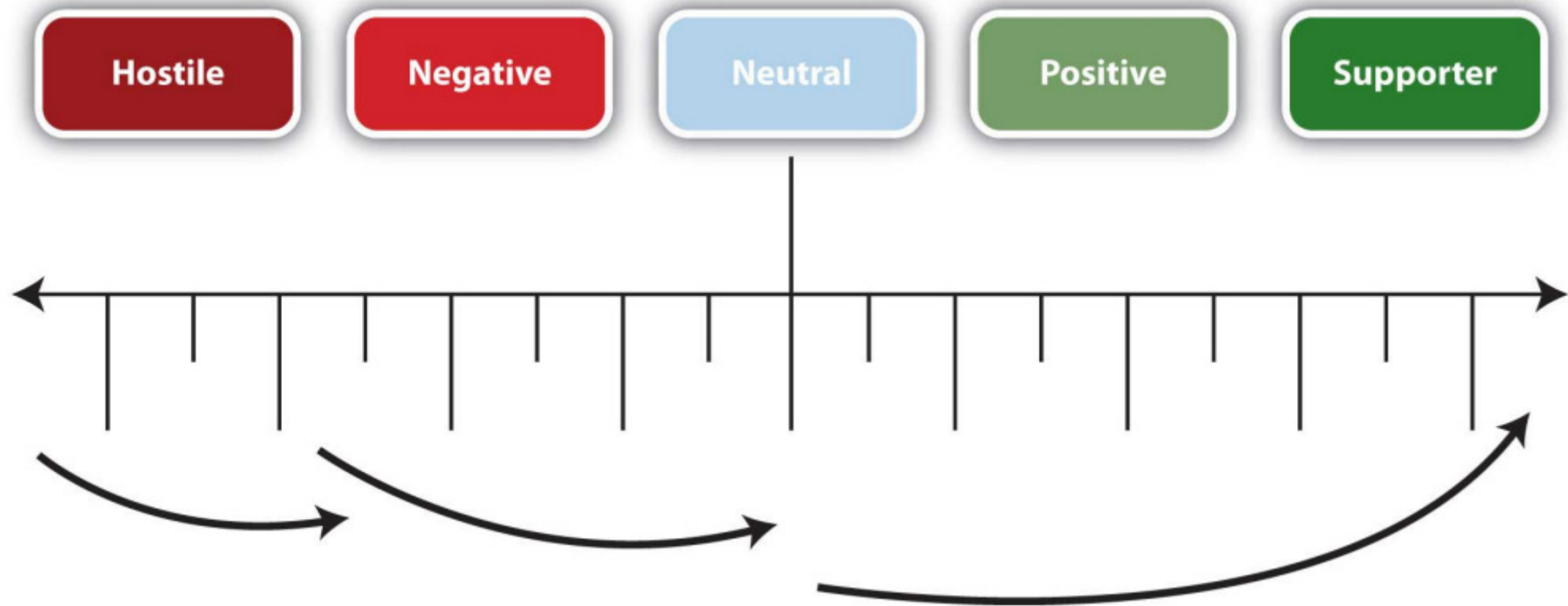
# Reasons for Engaging in Communication

- Gain information
- Understand communication contexts
- Understand our identity
- Meet our need

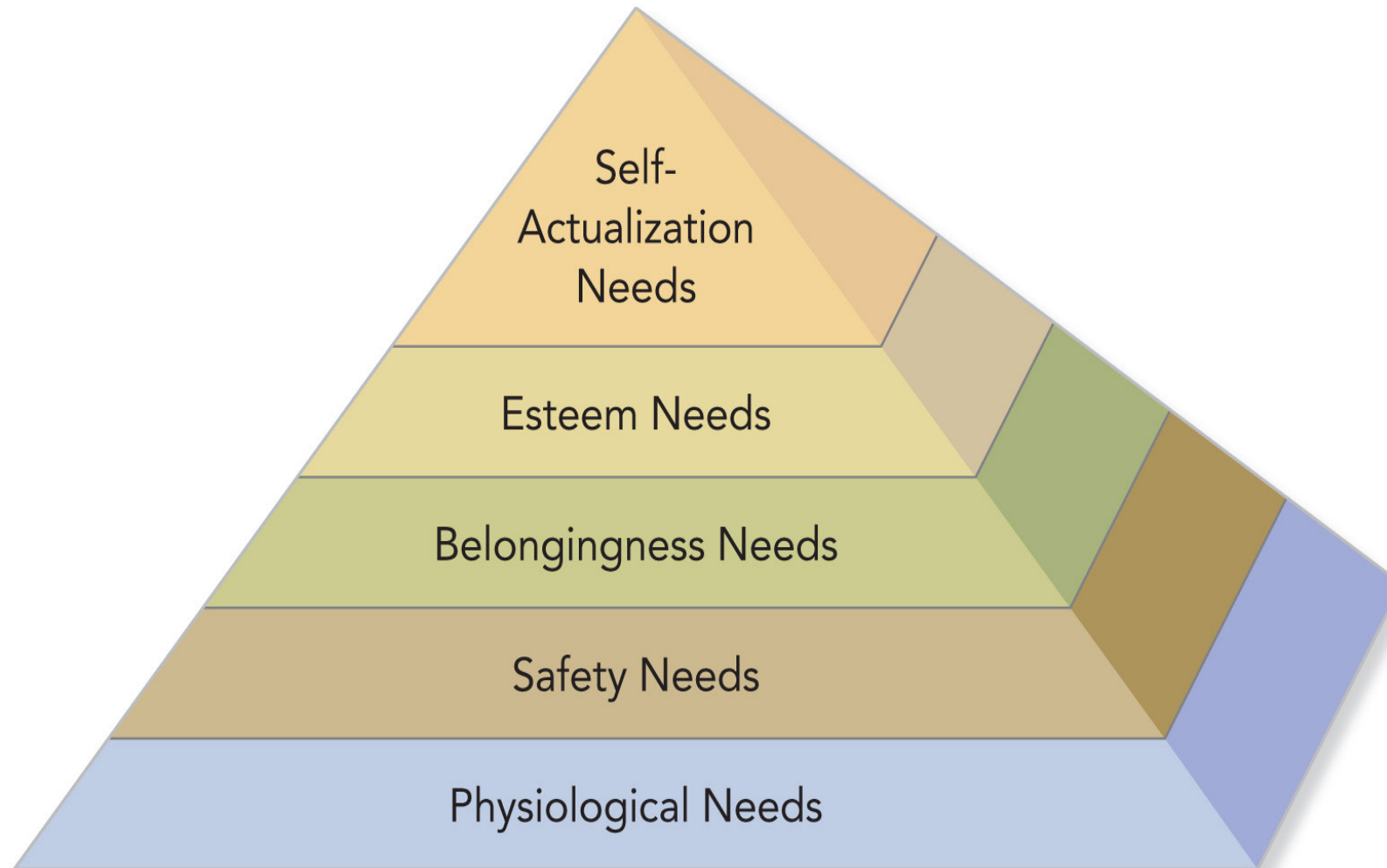
## 2. Meeting the Listener's Basic Needs

Getting someone to listen to what you have to say involves a measure of persuasion, and getting that person to act on it might require considerable skill.

# Measurable Gain

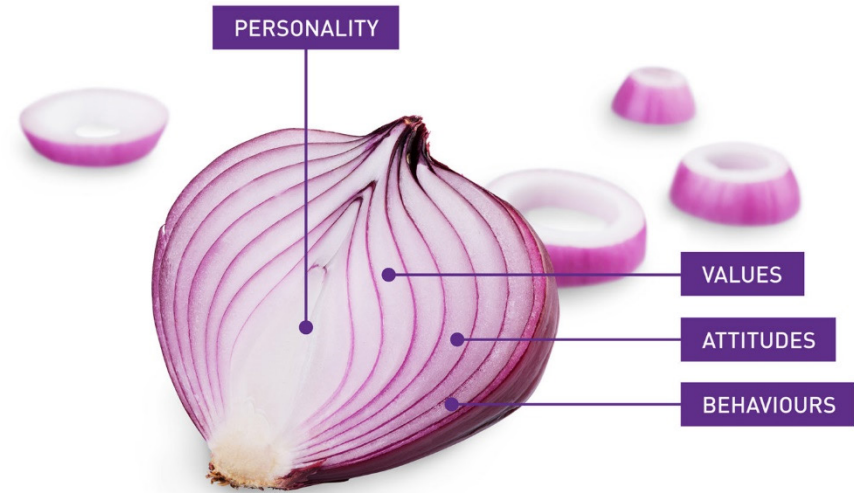


# Maslow's Hierarchy



# Social Penetration Theory

- ❑ **The social penetration theory**, which describes how we move from superficial talk to intimate and revealing talk (Altman, I. and Taylor, D., 1973).
- ❑ **“Onion model”**: we see how we start out on superficial level, but as we peel away the layers, we gain knowledge about the other person that encompasses both breadth and depth.



# 3. Speaking Ethically and Avoiding Fallacies

- ❖ Fairness
- ❖ Freedom
- ❖ Ethics
- ❖ Manipulation
- ❖ Deception
- ❖ Bias
- ❖ Bribery

# Eleven Points for Speaking Ethically

## DO NOT:

1. Use false, fabricated, misrepresented, distorted or irrelevant evidence to support arguments or claims.
2. Intentionally use unsupported, misleading, or illogical reasoning.
3. Represent yourself as informed or an “expert” on a subject when you are not.
4. Use irrelevant appeals to divert attention from the issue at hand.
5. Ask your audience to link your idea or proposal to emotion-laden values, motives, or goals to which it is actually not related.

# Eleven Points for Speaking Ethically

## DO NOT:

6. Deceive your audience by concealing your real purpose, by concealing self-interest, by concealing the group you represent, or by concealing your position as an advocate of a viewpoint.
7. Distort, hide, or misrepresent the number, scope, intensity, or undesirable features of consequences or effects.
8. Use “emotional appeals” that lack a supporting basis of evidence or reasoning.
9. Oversimplify complex, gradation-laden situations into simplistic, two-valued, either-or, polar views or choices.
10. Pretend certainty where tentativeness and degrees of probability would be more accurate.
11. Advocate something which you yourself do not believe in.

## 4. Elevator Speech

- ❖ An elevator speech is a presentation that persuades the listener in less than thirty seconds, or around a hundred words.
- ❖ It takes its name from the idea that in a short elevator ride (of perhaps ten floors), carefully chosen words can make a difference.

# Creating an Elevator Speech

1. What is the topic, product or service?
2. Who are you?
3. Who is the target market? (if applicable)
4. What is the revenue model? (if applicable)
5. What or who is the competition and what are your advantages?

# Parts of an Elevator Speech

| Speech Component    | Adapted to Elevator Speech              |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Attention Statement | Hook + information about you            |
| Introduction        | What you offer                          |
| Body                | Benefits; what's in it for the listener |
| Conclusion          | Example that sums it up                 |
| Residual Message    | Call for action                         |

# Example:

1. How are you doing?
2. Great! Glad you asked. I'm with (X Company) and we just received this new (product x)—it is amazing. It beats the competition hands down for a third of the price. Smaller, faster, and less expensive make it a winner. It's already a sales leader. Hey, if you know anyone who might be interested, call me! (Hands business card to the listener as visual aid)

# Activity

Prepare an elevator speech (no more than thirty seconds) and present to the class.

# Key Takeaway

1. Persuasion is the act of presenting arguments for change, while motivation involves the force to bring about change. The concept of measurable gain assesses audience response to a persuasive message.
2. We are motivated to communicate in order to gain information, get to know one another, better understand our situation or context, come to know ourselves and our role or identity, and meet our fundamental interpersonal needs.
3. Speaking to persuade should not involve manipulation, coercion, false logic, or other unethical techniques.
4. You often don't know when opportunity to inform or persuade will present itself, but with an elevator speech, you are prepared!

# Exercises

1. Select an online advertisement that you find particularly effective or ineffective. Why does it succeed, or fail, in persuading you to want to buy the advertised product? Discuss your ideas with your classmates.
2. Consider your life in relation to Maslow's hierarchy of needs. To what degree do you feel you have attained the different levels in the hierarchy? Two or three years ago, were you at the same level where you currently are, or has your position in the hierarchy changed? In what ways do you expect it to change in the future? Discuss your thoughts with your classmates.





**FPT UNIVERSITY**

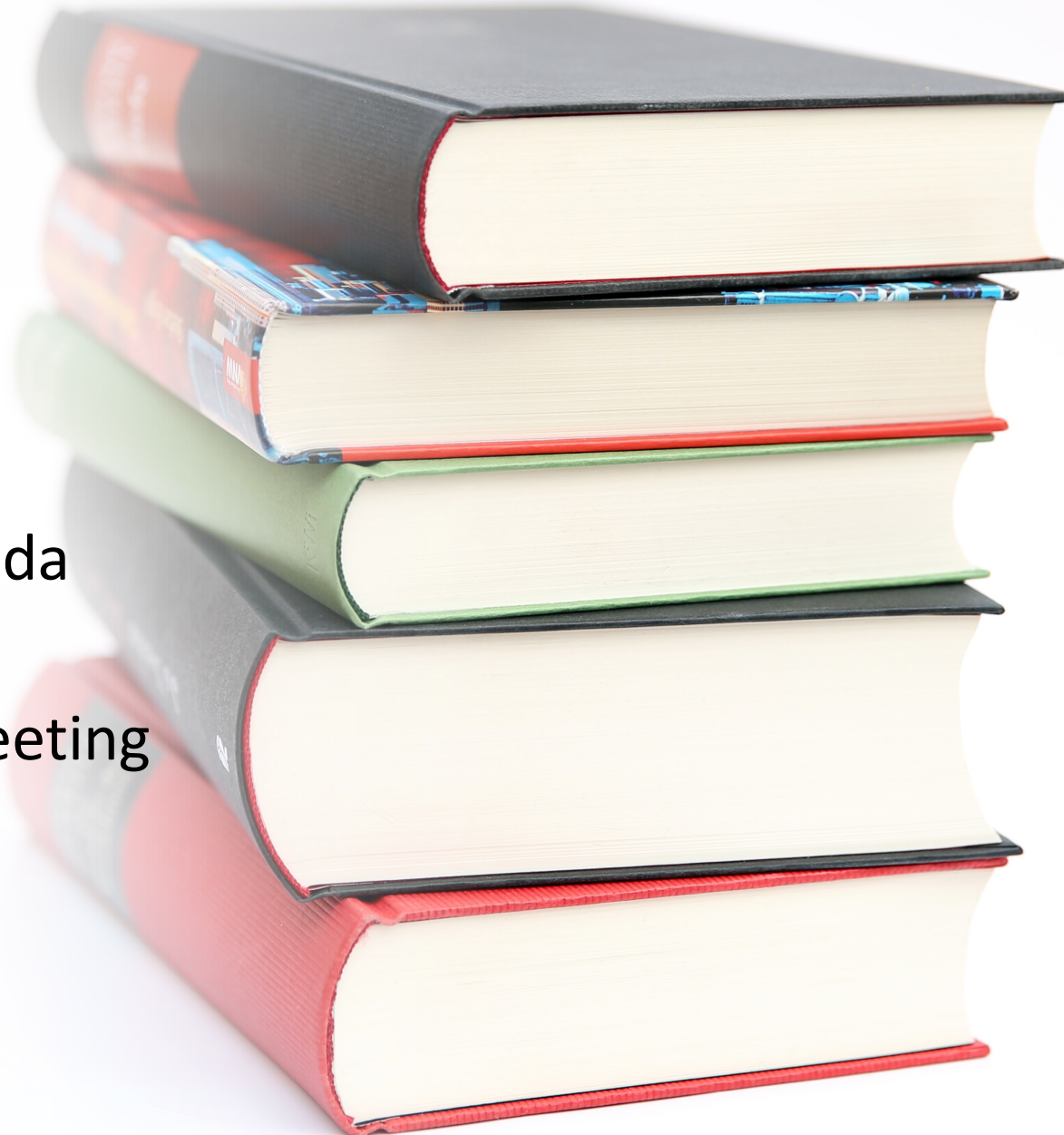
# Groups and meetings

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SESSION VI: GROUPS & TEAMS (IN)  
ACTION

# Chapter outlines

1. What is a meeting?
2. PRE-meeting
3. Components of agenda
4. POST-meeting  
communication – meeting  
minute / follow up
5. Using Technology



# LEARNING OBJECTIVES



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**By the end of this section, you will be able to:**

1. Discuss how to prepare for group meetings
2. Identify strategies for effectively facilitating meetings
3. Understand how to use technology to aid in group communications

## 1. What is a meeting?

- Meetings are a part of how groups get work done.
- Some view meetings as boring, pointless, and futile exercises
- Some see them as opportunities to exchange information and produce results.

Are you lonely?

Tired of working on your own?

Do you hate making decisions?

**HOLD A MEETING!**

*You can —*

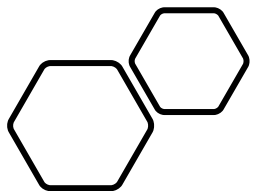
- See people
- Show charts
- Feel important
- Point with a stick
- Eat donuts
- Impress your colleagues

All on company time!



**MEETINGS**

THE PRACTICAL ALTERNATIVE TO WORK



## 2. PRE-meeting

- Needs a clear purpose statement
- Plan meeting schedule

|                                            |                                                                       |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Thursday, November 15</b>               |                                                                       |
| <b>Council Meeting</b>                     | <b>8:00 am - 7:00pm</b>                                               |
| <b>Closed Meeting</b>                      |                                                                       |
| <b>Thursday Evening Reception and Talk</b> |                                                                       |
| <b>7:00pm - 8:00pm - Keynote</b>           | <b>Giclas Hall</b><br>Mike West<br>Deputy Director Lowell Observatory |
| <b>Friday, November 16</b>                 |                                                                       |
| <b>8:00am - 8:45</b>                       | <b>Giclas Hall</b><br><b>Registration Opens &amp; Coffee</b>          |
| <b>Meetings</b>                            | <b>8:45 - 10:30</b>                                                   |
| <b>8:45am - 9:15 - Keynote</b>             | Dr. Jessie Christiansen                                               |
| <b>9:20 - 9:40</b>                         | Josch Hamsch                                                          |
| <b>9:45 - 10:05</b>                        | Richard Berry                                                         |
| <b>10:10 - 10:30</b>                       | Ken Steiner                                                           |
| <b>10:30 - 11:00</b>                       | Coffee Break                                                          |
| <b>Meetings</b>                            | <b>1:00 - 12:00</b>                                                   |
| <b>11:00 - 11:20</b>                       | Joyce Guzik                                                           |
| <b>11:25 - 11:45</b>                       | Ariana Hofelmann & Brian Hill                                         |
| <b>12:00 - 2:00pm</b>                      | <b>Bag Lunch Buffet - discussion with council</b>                     |
| <b>Meetings</b>                            | <b>2:00 - 3:30</b>                                                    |
| <b>2:00 - 2:30 - Keynote</b>               | Dr. Gerard VanBelle                                                   |
| <b>2:30 - 2:50</b>                         | Gary Billings                                                         |
| <b>3:00 - 3:30</b>                         | Stanley Gorodenski                                                    |
| <b>3:30 - 4:00</b>                         | Coffee Break                                                          |
| <b>Meetings</b>                            | <b>4:00 - 6:00</b>                                                    |
| <b>4:00 - 4:30 - Keynote</b>               | Dr. Arne Henden                                                       |
| <b>4:30 - 5:00pm</b>                       | <b>5 min presentations of 6 posters</b>                               |

# DECIDING HOW TO MEET

- Meeting in person:  
Need to decide how and where to meet.
- Virtual meetings: Use some of the technologies



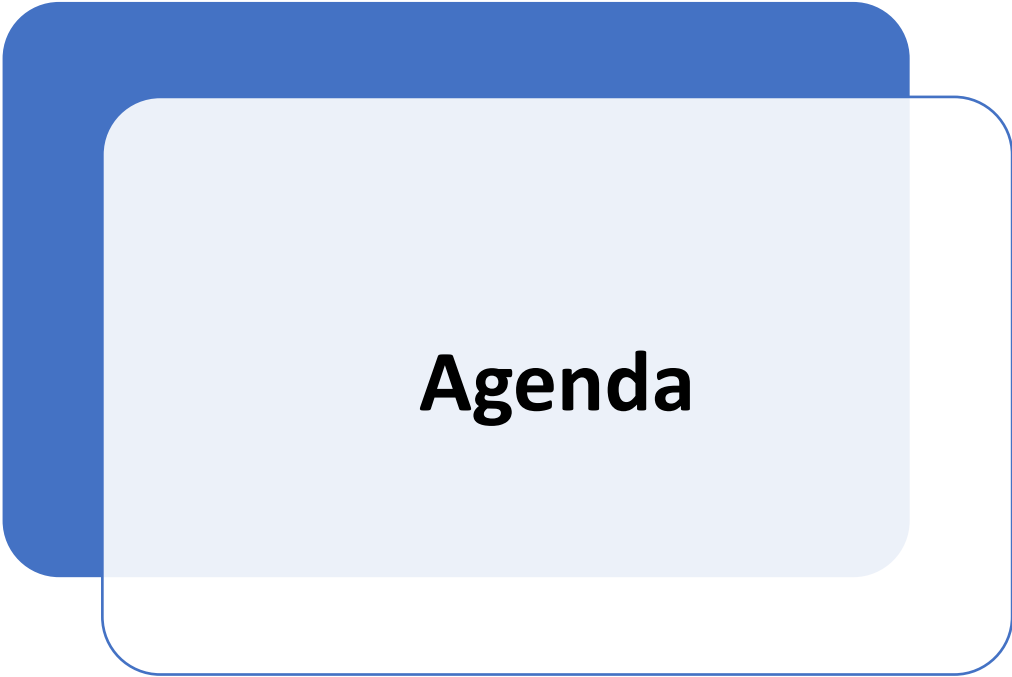
# Discussion

- Identify the strengths and weaknesses of face-to-face meetings?
- List types of effective application technologies for meetings?

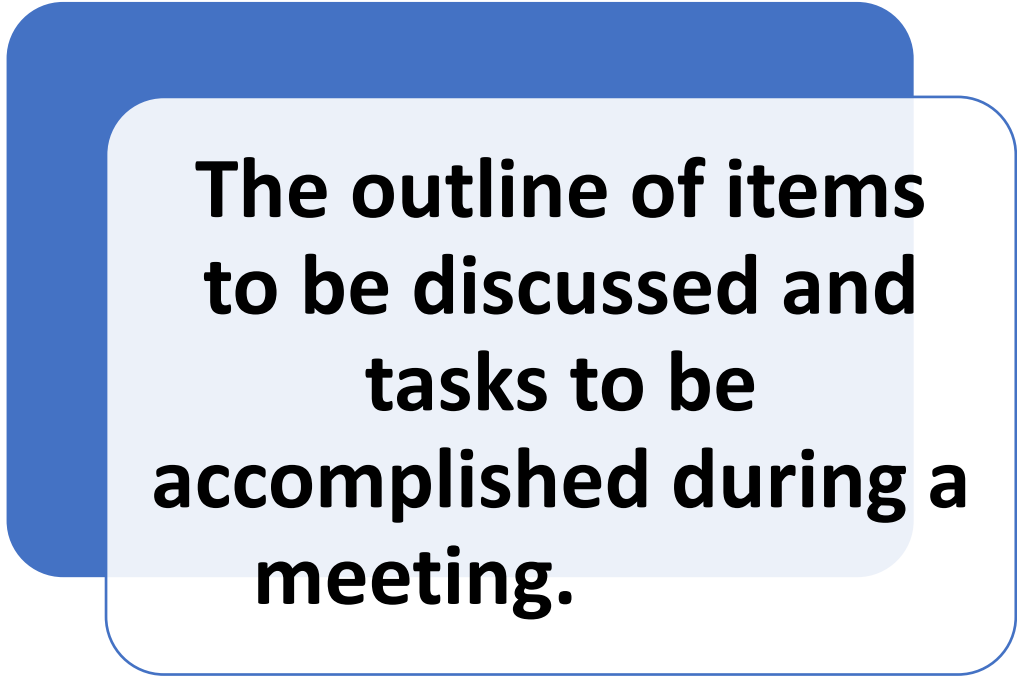




# FORMULATING AN AGENDA



**Agenda**



**The outline of items  
to be discussed and  
tasks to be  
accomplished during a  
meeting.**

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# 3. Components of agenda

- Purpose of Meeting
- A list of points to be considered, and a brief summary of relevant information that relates to each point.
- List of participants
- Date
- Time
- Place

DRAFT: 4 May 2021

## 6<sup>th</sup> ACT Accelerator Facilitation Council meeting

Livestreamed virtual meeting, 12 May 2021, 12:30 – 15:00 (CEST)

Co-hosts: Dr Tedros, Director General, WHO & Ms Stella Kyriakides, Commissioner for Health and Food Safety, European Commission

Co-Chairs: Dr Zwelini Mkhize, Minister of Health, South Africa & Mr Dag Ulstein, Minister of International Development, Norway

### Primary Objectives

- Identify barriers and strategies for increasing uptake and use of COVID-19 tools at country level
- Guide COVAX Task Force on strategies to expand COVID-19 vaccine production

### Draft Provisional Agenda

| Opening (10 min)                                                                                      |                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 12h30 – 12h40                                                                                         | Welcome                                                                                                      | • Co-Chairs & Co-Hosts opening remarks (10 min)                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Health Systems Connector: Facilitating uptake & delivery of COVID-19 tools (1hr 5 min), Chair: Norway |                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 12h40 – 13h45                                                                                         | Objective: Identify barriers and strategies for increasing uptake and use of COVID-19 tools at country level | • Facilitator: Professor Suerie Moon<br>• Interactive panel: 2-3 countries & CSO rep (20 min)<br>• Council discussion (38 min)<br>• HSC Principals comments in response to discussions (5 min)<br>• Chair's closing remarks (2 min)                      |
| Scale up of vaccine supply to COVAX (60 min), Chair: South Africa                                     |                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 13h45 – 14h45                                                                                         | Objective: Guide COVAX Task Force on strategies to expand COVID-19 Vaccine production                        | • Facilitator: Dr Ayoade Olatunbosun-Alakija<br>• Presentation from Council Working Group/ Task Force (10 min)<br>• Council Discussion (43 min)<br>• Council Working Group/ Task Force comments in response (5 min)<br>• Chair's closing remarks (2 min) |
| Progress on ACT-A resource mobilization (5 min)                                                       |                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 14h45 – 14h50                                                                                         | Objective: Progress on ACT-A resource mobilization                                                           | • Chair of Resource Mobilization Working Group                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Closing summary remarks and next steps (15 min)                                                       |                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 14h50 – 15h00                                                                                         | Meeting outcomes & next steps                                                                                | • Minister Mkhize & Minister Ulstein                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

# INVITING MEETING PARTICIPANTS

- ❖ **Adding additional participants for no clear reason** will only make the process more complex and may produce negative results.
- ❖ **Inviting the participants via e-mail** has become increasingly common across business and industry.
- ❖ **Software programs like Microsoft Outlook** allow you to initiate a meeting request and receive an “accept” or “decline” response that makes the invitation process organized and straightforward.
- ❖ **A reminder email on the day of the meeting**, often early in the morning, can serve as a personal effort to highlight the activities of the day.



## IDENTIFYING AN APPROPRIATE MEETING SPACE

- A table that is square, rectangular, or U-shaped
  - Tables that are round, or tables arranged in a circular pattern, allow for a more egalitarian model of interaction, reducing the hierarchical aspects while reinforcing the clear line of sight among all participants.
- 



# MEETING CHECKLIST FOR PARTICIPANTS

**Mary Ellen Guffey (2007) provides a useful participant checklist that is adapted here for our use:**

- ❖ Arrive on time and stay until the meeting adjourns (unless there are prior arrangements)
- ❖ Leave the meeting only for established breaks or emergencies
- ❖ Be prepared and have everything you need on hand
- ❖ Turn off cell phones and personal digital assistants
- ❖ Follow the established protocol for turn taking
- ❖ Respect time limits
- ❖ Demonstrate professionalism in your verbal and nonverbal interactions
- ❖ Communicate interest and stay engaged in the discussion
- ❖ Avoid tangents and side discussions
- ❖ Respect space and don't place your notebook or papers all around you
- ❖ Clean up after yourself
- ❖ Engage in polite conversation after the conclusion



# Perils of Poor Facilitation

- ❖ An argument starts about an established fact.
- ❖ Opinions are introduced as if they were truths.
- ❖ People intimidate others with real or imaginary “knowledge.”
- ❖ People overwhelm each other with too many proposals for the time available to consider them.
- ❖ People become angry for no good reason.
- ❖ People promote their own visions at the expense of everyone else’s.
- ❖ People demand or offer much more information than is needed.
- ❖ Discussion becomes circular; people repeat themselves without making any progress toward conclusions.

# Guidelines for Facilitating a Meeting

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1. Start promptly
2. Begin with something positive
3. Tend to housekeeping details
4. Make sure people understand their roles
5. Keep to your agenda
6. Guide, don't dictate
7. Keep your eyes open for nonverbal communication
8. Capture and assign action items



# Guidelines for Facilitating a Meeting

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9. Make things fun and healthy
10. Avoid sarcasm and cynicism.
11. Take breaks regularly, even when you think you don't need them
12. Show respect for everyone
13. Expect the unexpected
14. Conduct multiple assessments of the meeting. Formative assessment
15. Think (and talk) ahead





## 4. POST-Meeting Communication

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Summarizing what has been discussed or decided, and what actions the group members are to take as a result of the meeting.

Finalize the **minutes** of the meeting: notes in relation to actions taken during the meeting or specific indications of who is responsible for what before the next meeting.



# Sample of Informal Minutes

## **Domestic Violence Class Discussion Group Meeting February 10, 2009, in Library Conference Room 215**

Present: Gabriella Hernandez (chairperson), Eric Beck,  
Terri Harrison, Will Mabry, Tracey Tibbs

Absent: Lance Nickens

Meeting began at 2:00 P.M.

**Group Topic:** The group discussed whether emotional and verbal abuse should be included in the project. Since we don't have much time to do our presentation, we decided to limit the topic to physical abuse only.

**Research Assignments:** Since the assignment is due in two weeks, we decided to divide the issue into different topics and research them on our own.

*Action: Eric will research why people stay in abusive relationships.*

*Action: Gabriella will research the effects on the children.*

*Action: Terri will find statistics and examples of the seriousness of the problem.*

*Action: Will is going to find out why and how the abuse happens.*

*Action: Tracey will find out what resources are available in the area for victims.*

Members will report on their research at the next meeting.

**Absent Members:** Lance has not been to the last two class meetings. We don't know if he is still going to participate in the group. *Action: Gabriella will call Lance.*

**Class Presentation:** We need to think of creative ways to make a presentation to the class. The group decided to think about this and discuss it at the next meeting.

**Next Meeting:** Our next meeting will be at 2:30 on Tuesday, February 14th, in the same place. *Action: Terri will reserve the room.*

The meeting ended at 3:15 P.M.

## 5. Using Technology

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- Using Technology to Facilitate Meetings
- Audio-Only Interactions
- Audio-Visual Interactions





# TIPS FOR VIRTUAL MEETINGS

1. Get all the participants in an audio meeting to say something brief at the start of the meeting so that everyone becomes familiar with everyone else's voice.
2. Remind people of the purpose of the meeting and of the key outcome(s) you hope to achieve together.
3. Listen/watch for people who aren't participating and ask them periodically if they have thoughts or suggestions to add to the discussion.
4. Summarize the status of the meeting from time to time.
5. If you're holding an audio conference, discourage people from calling in on a cell phone because of potential problems with sound quality.
6. Because you may not have nonverbal cues to refer to, ask other members to clarify their meanings and intentions if you're not sure their words alone convey all you need to know.
7. If you know you're going to have to leave a meeting before it ends, inform the organizer in advance. Sign off publicly, but quickly, when you leave rather than just hanging up on the meeting connection.



# Review & Reflection Questions

- ❖ Imagine you are about to meet with your group for the first time. What are key steps you want to consider in preparing for a meeting? What items might you want to include on your first agenda?
- ❖ Reflect on meetings you have attended in the past. What strategies have you observed facilitators use? What did you find to be effective and ineffective?
- ❖ How might you use technology to conduct a group meeting? What might be the advantages and disadvantages?

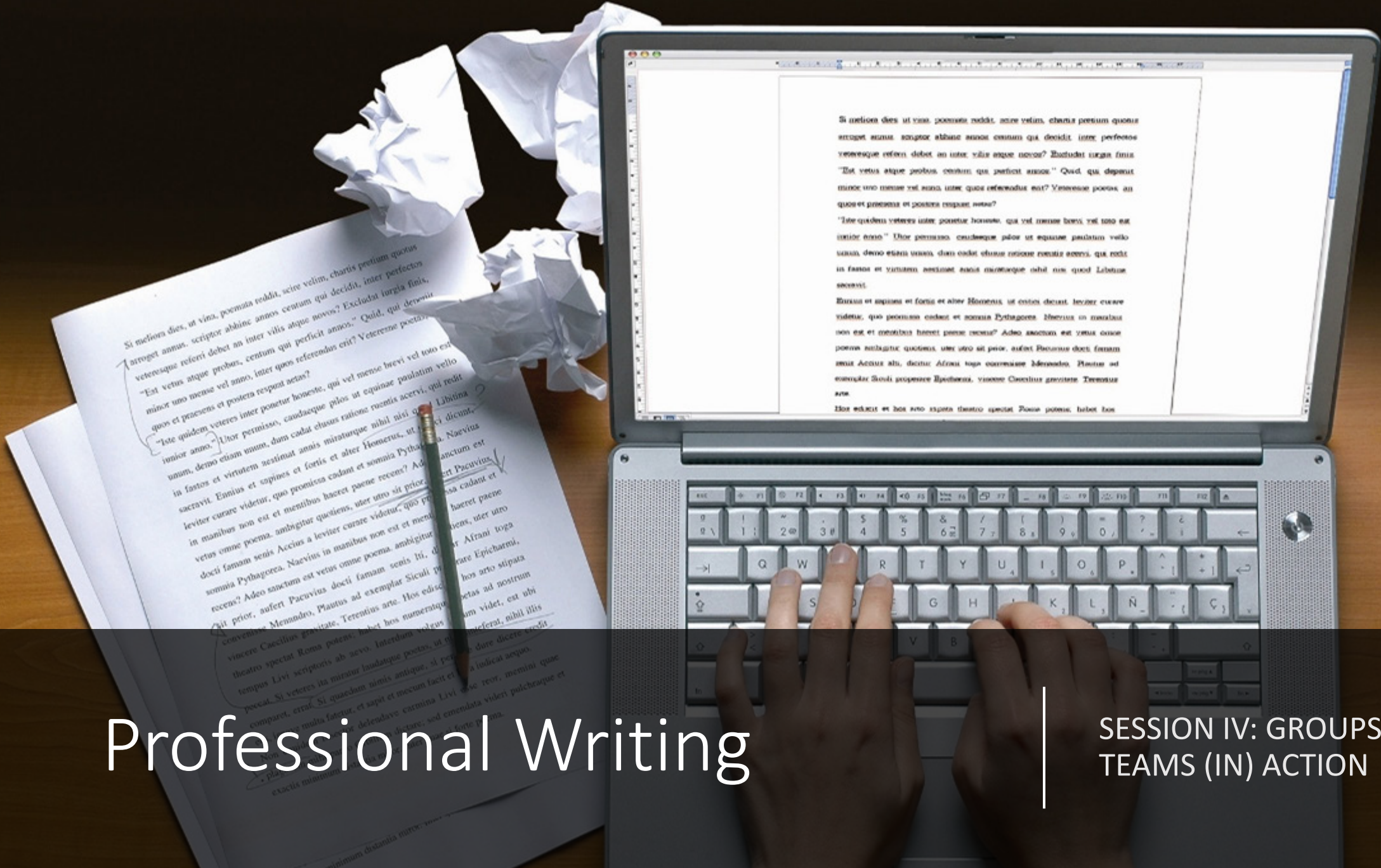


Q&A

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# Professional Writing

SESSION IV: GROUPS &  
TEAMS (IN) ACTION



# Chapter outlines

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1. Think, then write: Writing preparation
2. A Planning Checklist for Business Messages
3. General Revision Points to Consider
4. Specific Revision Points to Consider
5. Style Revisions



# LEARNING OBJECTIVES

**By the end of this section, you will be able to:**

1. Discuss the process of writing preparation
2. List a Planning Checklist for Business Messages
3. List three general elements of every document that require revision
4. List six specific elements of every document to check for revision
5. Discuss and demonstrate the use of twelve points to consider for style revisions.

# Introduction

- ❖ You learned to speak and to write and, like all humans, your skill in speaking and writing can continue to improve and adapt across your lifetime. The awareness of this simple fact should encourage you to write.
- ❖ What kinds of skills, or strengths, will you need in order to write well enough to succeed in your career? Solid research skills combined with effective preparation for writing involve a range of skill sets that require time and practice.
- ❖ Regardless of what you write, there exists the possibility, even probability, that misunderstandings and miscommunications can and will occur.

# 1. Think, then write: Writing preparation

- ❖ Consider one important step to writing success: ***know when you are most productive.***
- ❖ Don't wait to be in the "right mood" to write. If you wait for the right mood to strike, you will probably never get started at all.
- ❖ Develop a habit of concentrating when you write. Our busy lives involve constant interruption, our minds can multitask and perform several tasks simultaneously, but we can also get easily distracted.

## 1.1. Think critically

- ❖ The false thinking strategy leads to poor conclusions. Critical thinking requires a willingness to acknowledge and address our own tendency for ***confirmation bias, egocentrism, and sociocentrism***.
- ❖ As you read, research, and prepare for writing, make an effort to gather information from ***a range of reliable sources***, whether or not this information leads to conclusions you didn't expect.
- ❖ Reading and writing from an ***audience-centered view*** means acknowledging your confirmation bias and moving beyond it to consider *multiple frames of references, points of view, and perspectives* as you read, research, and write.

## 1.1. Think critically

❖ **Confirmation bias:** when you only pay attention to information that reinforces your existing beliefs and ignore or discredit information that contradicts your beliefs.

Example: a person believes the earth is flat. He decides to look for information but only finds information that supports his pre-existing belief, ignoring or discrediting information that contradicts that belief.

❖ **Egocentrism:** the use of self-centered standards to determine what to believe and what to reject.

Example: a person believes the earth is flat and never questions that belief.

❖ **Sociocentrism** involves the use of society-centered standards to determine what to believe and what to reject.

Example: a person believes the earth is flat because everyone in his group or community believes it, even though he himself has never questioned or confirmed the belief.

## 1.2. Overcome fear of writing

- ❖ Having a positive attitude about writing in general, and your effort, is also a key ingredient to your success. Therefore, you need to acknowledge any reluctance or fear that may be holding you back, and bring your interests and enthusiasm to this discussion on writing.
- ❖ People often fear the writing process because of three main reasons:
  - Negative orientation
  - Risk of failure
  - Fear of the unknown

## 1.2. Overcome fear of writing

1. **Negative orientation:** the writer has a pre-existing negative association or view of the task or activity.

Solution: If you have a negative orientation toward writing, admitting this fact is an important first step. Next, we need to actively seek ways to develop your skills in ways that will demonstrate measurable gain and lead to positive affirmation

2.. **Risk of failure:** a common fear across public speaking and writing situations, producing predictable behavioral patterns we can recognize, address, and resolve. This fear can lead to an overwhelming feeling of not knowing what to write or where to start—and sit helplessly waiting for our situation to change

Solution: let go of your perfectionist tendencies. Writing won't be perfect the first time you attempt it. Writing is a process, so firstly, make a rough draft, then have a second (or third) chance to get it right. Your desire for perfection will serve you well when it comes to polishing your finished document

3. **Fear of the unknown:** If you have never written a formal business report, your fear of the unknown is understandable

Solution: Make the unknown known. If we take the mystery out of the process and product, we can see it for its essential components, its organizational pattern, and start to see how our product may look before we even start to produce it. Your goal is to become familiar with the type of document and to examine several successful examples. Once you see a couple of reports, you will have a better feel for what you have to produce and the unknown will be far less mysterious

## 2. A Planning Checklist for Business Messages

1. Determine your **general purpose**: are you trying to inform, persuade, entertain, facilitate interaction, or motivate a reader?
2. Determine your **specific purpose** (the desired outcome).
3. Make sure your purpose is realistic.
4. Make sure your **timing** is appropriate.
5. Make sure your **sources** are credible.
6. Make sure the message reflects positively on your business.
7. Determine **audience size**.
8. Determine **audience composition**.
9. Determine **audience knowledge** and **awareness of topic**.
10. Anticipate **probable responses**.
11. Select the correct channel.
12. Make sure the information provided is accurate, ethical, and pertinent

# Determining your purpose

- ❖ All acts of communication have general and specific purposes, and the degree to which you can identify these purposes will influence how effective your writing is.
- ❖ **General purposes** involve the overall goal of the communication interaction: to inform, persuade, entertain, facilitate interaction, or motivate a reader
- ❖ **Specific purposes:** every piece of writing also has at least one specific purpose, which is the intended outcome; the result that will happen once your written communication has been read.

# Determining your purpose

You will need to cover several predictable elements:

- Who
- What
- When
- Where
- How
- Why

### 3. General Revision Points to Consider

- ❖ Evaluate Content
- ❖ Evaluate Organization
- ❖ Evaluate Style
- ❖ Evaluate Readability

# Activity

Find a particularly good example of writing according to the above criteria. Review it and share it with your classmates.



## 4. Specific Revision Points to Consider

1. Format
2. Facts
3. Names
4. Spelling
5. Punctuation
6. Grammar

# Activity

Find an example of an error in a published document and share it with classmates.



## 5. Style Revisions

- Break Up Long Sentences
- Revise Big Words and Long Phrases
- Evaluate Long Prepositional Phrases
- Delete Repetitious Words
- Eliminate Archaic Expressions or References
- Avoid Fillers



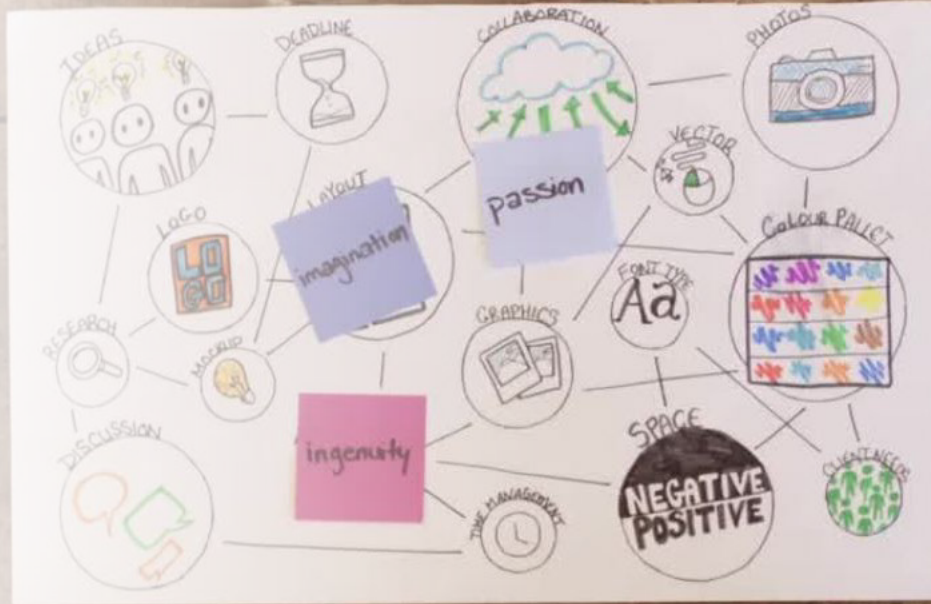
## 5. Style Revisions (Cont)

- Eliminate Slang
- Evaluate Clichés
- Emphasize Precise Words
- Evaluate Parallel Construction
- Obscured Verbs
- The “Is It Professional?” Test



# Activity

Find an example of a bad example of effective business writing, review it, and share it with your classmates.



# Activity

Select a piece of writing from a Web site, book, newspaper, or magazine. Imagine that you are editing it half its original length. Share the article and your revised copy with your classmates.



# KEY TAKEAWAY

1. There are several reasons why people fear writing, but there are also several strategies to reduce or eliminate those fears.
2. The following twelve-item checklist serves as a useful reminder of the importance of preparation in the writing process
3. The four main categories—content, organization, style, and readability—provide a template for general revision.
4. By revising for format, facts, names, spelling, punctuation, and grammar, you can increase your chances of correcting many common errors in your writing.
5. Revising for style can increase a document's clarity, conciseness, and professionalism.

# EXERCISES



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1. Find an example of an error in a published document and share it with classmates.
2. Find an example of a good example of effective business writing, review it, and share it with your classmates.
3. With a writing assignment in draft form from your class, swap with a classmate and review the spelling, grammar, and punctuation, using proofreading marks where applicable.

Q&A





# Business writing in action

SESSION IV: GROUPS & TEAMS (IN) ACTION



# LEARNING OBJECTIVES

**By the end of this section, you will be able to:**

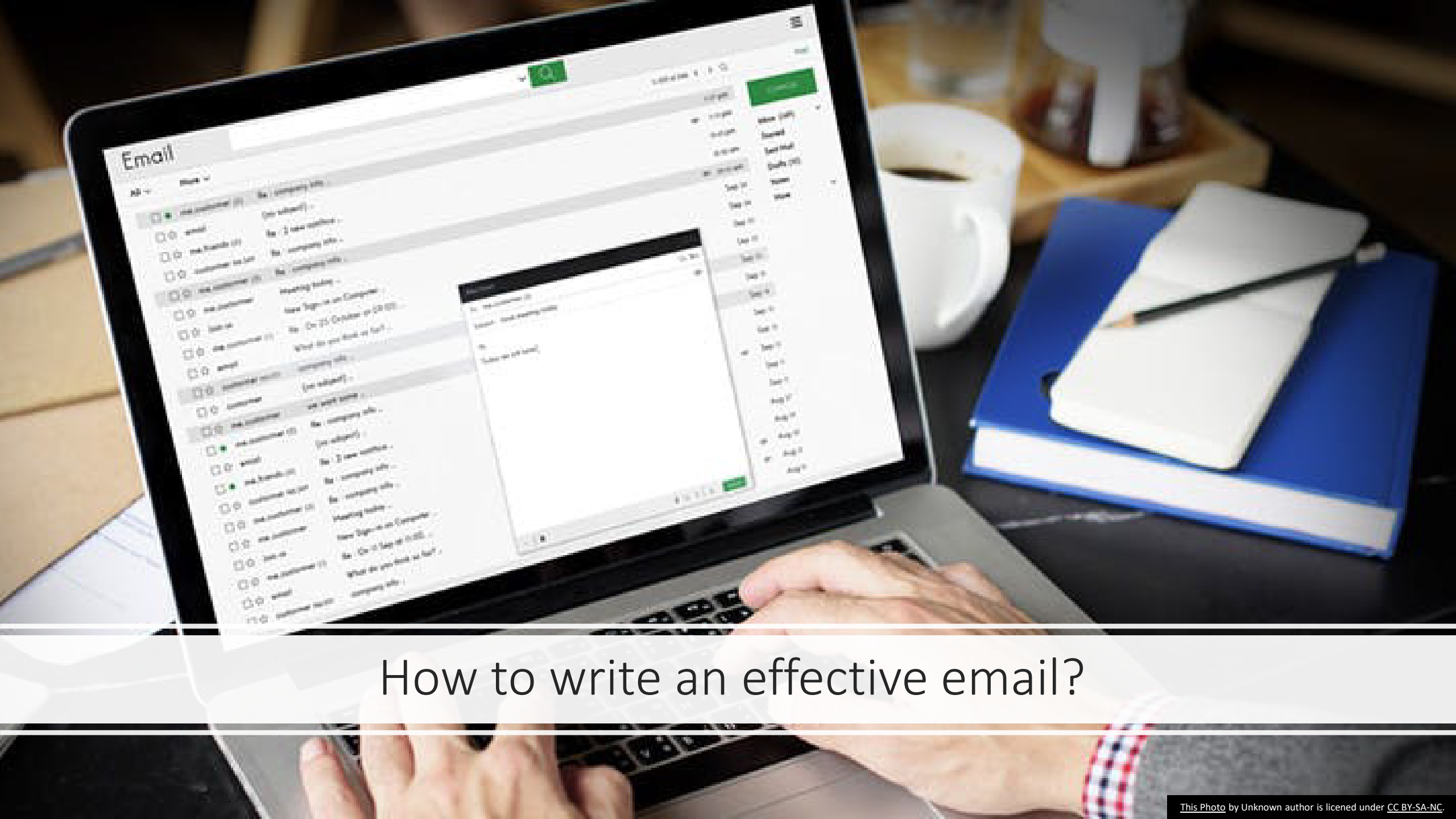
1. Discuss the role of text messaging in business communication.
2. Write effective emails for both internal and external communication.
3. Discuss the purpose and format of a memo.

# 1. Email

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- Electronic mail, usually called e-mail
- It may be used like text, or synchronous chat, and it can be delivered to a cell phone.





How to write an effective email?



# How to write an effective email?

**1. Proper salutations** should demonstrate respect and avoid mix-ups in case a message is accidentally sent to the wrong recipient.

For example, use a salutation like “Dear Ms. X” (external) or “Hi Barry” (internal).

# How to write an effective email? (Cont)

**2. Subject lines** should be clear, brief, and specific. This helps the recipient understand the essence of the message.

For example, “Proposal attached” or “Your question of 10/25.”

# How to write an effective email? (Cont)

## **3. Close with a signature.**

Identify yourself by creating a signature block that automatically contains your name and business contact information.

Sincerely,

FALCON ACCOUNTING

*Jamie Falcon*

(Ms.) Jamie Falcon, President

# How to write an effective email? (Cont)

**4. Avoid abbreviations.** An e-mail is not a text message, and the audience may not find your wit cause to ROTFLOL (roll on the floor laughing out loud).

**5. Be brief.** Omit unnecessary words.

# How to write an effective email? (Cont)

## **6. Use a good format**

Include line breaks between sentences or divide your message into brief paragraphs for ease of reading.

A good e-mail should get to the point and conclude in three small paragraphs or less

## How to write an effective email? (Cont)

7. Reread, revise, and review.

8. Reply promptly

9. Use “Reply All” sparingly

10. Avoid using all caps.

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# How to write an effective email? (Cont)

11. Test links. If you include a link, test it to make sure it is complete.

12. E-mail ahead of time if you are going to attach large files to prevent exceeding the recipient's mailbox limit or triggering the spam filter.

13. Give feedback or follow up.

# Activity

Find an example of an e-mail that you wish you had never sent or received.

Rewrite it to eliminate the characteristics that you find problematic.

Share it with your classmates.

## 2. Memorandums and Letters

- **Memos:** (or memorandum, meaning “reminder”) is normally used for communicating policies, procedures, or related official business within an organization.
- **Letters** are brief messages sent to recipients that are often outside the organization.

### The Memo

Speed



Formality



#### Current Purposes:

- To communicate within an organization, usually to a large group of people.
- To broadcast a message (rather than have a conversation).



## 2.1 Memo Format

- **Use**
  - To:
  - From:
  - Date:
  - Subject:
- **Writer signs** or writes initials near keyed name in the heading

To: All Employees  
From: Larry Ogawa, President, University of State  
Date: February 14, 2009  
Subject: Future Expenditure Guidelines

After careful deliberation, I have determined it is necessary to begin the initial steps of a financial stewardship program that carries UState through what appears to be a two-year cycle of a severe state shortfall in revenue and subsequent necessary legislative budget reductions.

Beginning February 9, 2009, the following actions are being implemented for the General Fund, Auxiliary Fund, and Capital Fund in order to address the projected reductions in our state aid for the remainder of this year 2008–09 and for next year 2009–10.

1. Only purchases needed to operate the university should be made so that we can begin saving to reduce the impact of 2009–10 budget reductions.
2. Requests for out-of-state travel will require approval from the Executive Committee to ensure that only necessary institutional travel occurs.
3. Purchases, including in-state travel and budget transfers, will require the appropriate vice president's approval.

Please understand that we are taking these prudent steps to create savings that will allow UState to reduce the impact of projected cuts in expected 2009–10 legislative reductions. Thank you for your cooperation, and please direct any questions to my office.

# How to write effective Business Memos

1. Audience Orientation
2. Professional, Formal Tone
3. Subject Emphasis
4. Direct Format
5. Objectivity

# 2.2

## Elements of a Business Letter

- 
1. Return Address
  2. Date
  3. Reference (Re:)
  4. Delivery (Optional)
  5. Recipient Note (Optional)
  6. Salutation
  7. Introduction
  8. Body
  9. Conclusion
  10. Close
  11. Signature
  12. Preparation Line
  13. Enclosures/ Attachments
  14. Courtesy Copies or “CC”
  15. Logo/ Contact Information

(1 inch margins on all sides of the letter)

1. **Return Address:** (if not in letterhead logo)

2. **Date:** 01/01/201X

3. **Reference—Re:** How to write a letter

4. **Delivery** (optional): USPS Certified Mail #123456789

5. **Recipient Note** (optional): Confidential

6. **Salutation:** Dear Student X:

7. **Introduction:** This letter is to inform you that the myth of a paperless office, where you will not be required to produce hard copy letters on letterhead, is a myth.

8. **Body:** While e-mail has largely replaced letter writing for many applications, there remain several reasons for producing a hard copy letter. The first reason is that you are required to write it for this class, as many employers still produce letters as a normal part of business communication, including documentation. Next, we must consider that paper sales in business have increased across the last decade, showing no signs of the decrease we would associate with the transition to the paperless office. Finally, business letters serve many functions, and your proficiency in their efficient and effective production will contribute to your personal and professional success.

9. **Conclusion:** Letter writing is a skill that will continue to be required in the business environment of today and tomorrow.

10. **Close:** Sincerely,

11. **Signature Line:** Scott McLean

12. **Preparation Line:** GSM/ep

13. **Enclosures:** (optional, if needed)

14. **Courtesy Copies:** cc: Jenn Yee

15. **Logo/Contact Information:**



13 N. Mill Street  
Nyack, NY 10960

# Strategies for Effective Letters

**remember that a letter has five main areas:**

1. The heading, which establishes the sender, often including address and date
2. The introduction, which establishes the purpose
3. The body, which articulates the message
4. The conclusion, which restates the main point and may include a call to action
5. The signature line, which sometimes includes the contact information

To communicate  
effectively and  
project a  
positive image

- be clear, concise, specific, and respectful;
- each word should contribute to your purpose;
- each paragraph should focus on one idea;
- the parts of the letter should form a complete message;
- the letter should be free of errors.

# Exercises

1. Create a draft letter introducing a product or service to a new client.  
Post and share with classmates.
2. Write a memo informing your class that an upcoming holiday will be observed. Post and share with classmates.





**FPT UNIVERSITY**

# Writing a report

Session IV: Groups & Teams (In) Action

# Chapter outlines

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1. What Is a Report?
2. Types of Reports

# Learning objectives

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**By the end of this section, you will be able to:**

- Describe the main parts of a report.
- Understand the different types of reports.
- Write a basic report.

# Result



## 1. What Is a Report?

- **Reports** are documents designed to record and convey information to the reader.
- **Reports** are part of any business or organization; from credit reports to police reports, they serve to document specific information for specific audiences, goals, or functions.

## 2. Types of Reports

- ❖ Reports come in all sizes, but are typically longer than a page and somewhat shorter than a book.
- ❖ The type of report depends on its function.



# Types of Reports & Their Functions

- Laboratory report
- Research report
- Filed study report
- Progress report
- Technical report
- Financial report
- Case study
- Needs assessment report
- Comparative advantage report
- Feasibility study



# Types of Reports & Their Functions (Cont)

- Instruction manuals
- Compliance report
- Cost-benefit analysis report
- Decision report
- Benchmark report
- Examination report
- Physical description report
- Literature review

# How Are Reports Organized?

**Reports are typically organized around six key elements:**

1. Whom the report is about and/or prepared for
2. What was done, what problems were addressed, and the results, including conclusions and/or recommendations
3. Where the subject studied occurred
4. When the subject studied occurred
5. Why the report was written (function), including under what authority, for what reason, or by whose request
6. How the subject operated, functioned, or was used

# Ten Common Elements of a Report

|                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Cover             | Title and image                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 2. Title Fly         | Title only                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 3. Title Page        | Label, report, features title, author, affiliation, date, and sometimes for whom the report was prepared                                                                                                                     |
| 4. Table of Contents | A list of the main parts of the report and their respective page numbers                                                                                                                                                     |
| 5. Abstract          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Informational abstract: highlight topic, methods, data, and results</li><li>• Descriptive abstract: (All of the above without statements of conclusion or recommendations)</li></ul> |
| 6. Introduction      | Introduces the topic of the report                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 7. Body              | Key elements of body include: <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Background • Methodology • Results • Analysis and Recommendations</li></ul>                                                                            |
| 8. Conclusion        | Concise presentation of findings                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 9. References        | Bibliography or Works Cited                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 10. Appendix         | Related supporting materials                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

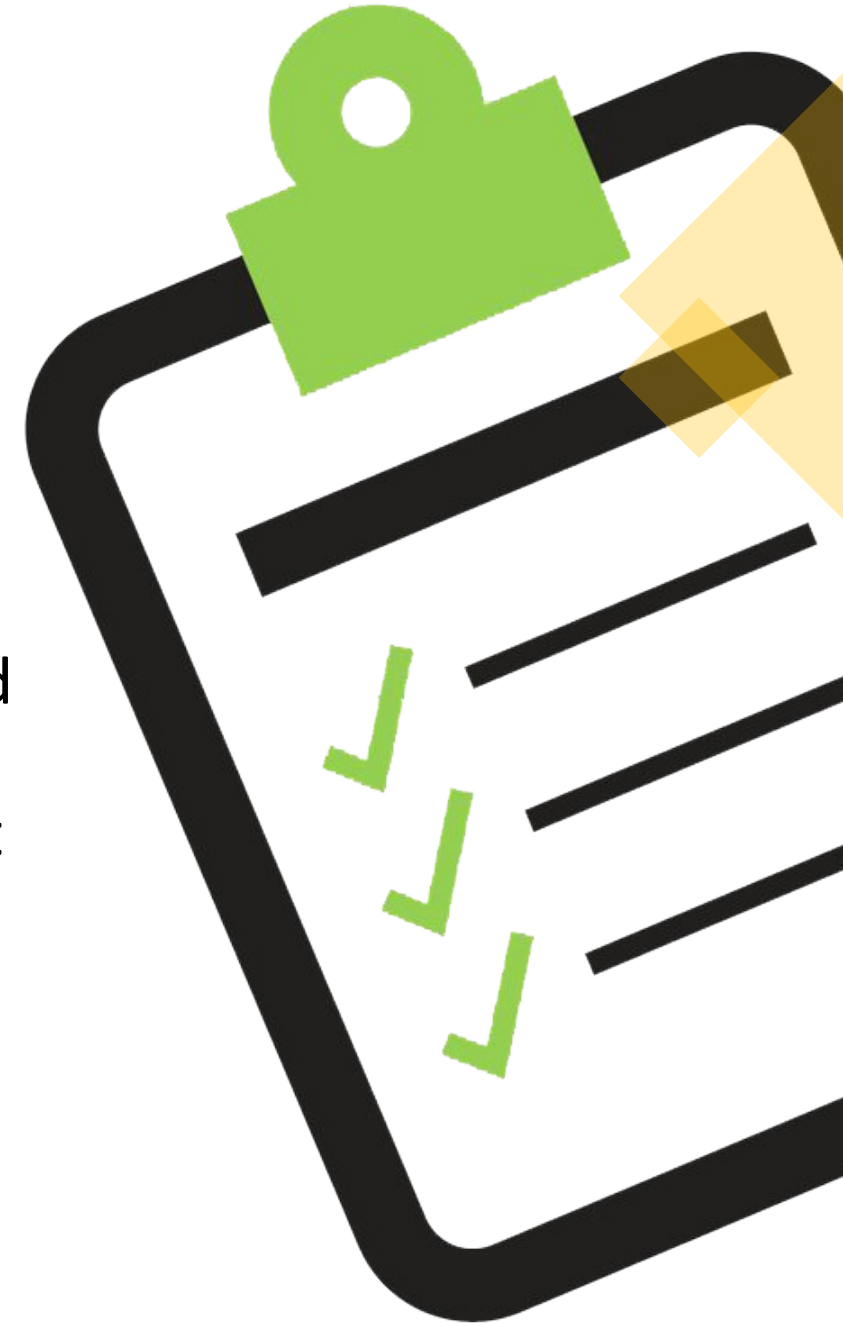
# The checklist for ensuring that a report fulfills its goals

1. Report considers the audience's needs
2. Format follows function of report
3. Format reflects institutional norms and expectations
4. Information is accurate, complete, and documented
5. Information is easy to read



# The checklist for ensuring that a report fulfills its goals

6. Terms are clearly defined
7. Figures, tables, and art support written content
8. Figures, tables, and art are clear and correctly labeled
9. Figures, tables, and art are easily understood without text support
10. Words are easy to read (font, arrangement, organization)



# The checklist for ensuring that a report fulfills its goals (Cont)

- 11. Results are clear and concise
- 12. Recommendations are reasonable and well-supported
- 13. Report represents your best effort
- 14. Report speaks for itself without your clarification or explanation





# Activity

Design a survey to evaluate the effectiveness of the project your group is working on.

# Exercises

1. Find an annual report for a business you would like to learn more about. Review it with the previous reading in mind and provide examples. Share and compare with classmates.



# Exercises

2. Write a report on a trend in business that you've observed, and highlight at least the main finding. For example, from the rising cost of textbooks to the online approach to course content, textbooks are a significant issue for students. Draw from your experience as you bring together sources of information to illustrate a trend. Share and compare with classmates.



